

Fishing for Beginners - Printable Pack

From *Fishing for Beginners* by Harry Renshaw (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

Appendix A - Hook Sizes, Line Strengths and What to Use for What

Hook sizes. The numbers run backwards up to 1, then forwards with a slash: 22, 20, 18, 16, 14, 12, 10, 8, 6, 4, 2, 1, 1/0, 2/0, 3/0, 4/0, 5/0, 6/0. Size 20 is a few millimetres; 6/0 is the length of a finger.

Hook size	Bait	Fish
18 to 20	One maggot, a pinch of bread	Roach, dace, small perch, bluegill in winter
14 to 16	Two maggots, a grain of corn, a small piece of worm	Roach, perch, bluegill, crappie, small carp, stocked trout
10 to 12	A worm, two grains of corn, bread flake	Perch, tench, bream, carp, chub, trout, bass
6 to 8	A whole nightcrawler, a boilie on a hair, a minnow, cut bait	Carp, catfish, bass, walleye, chub, eels
2 to 4	Big baits, a dead bait for pike (on trebles or singles), a strip of fish	Pike, big catfish, sea fish from piers
1/0 to 3/0	Worm, squid, crab, cut fish, soft plastics for stripers and sea bass	Flounder, sea bass, striped bass, redfish, mackerel on feathers (size

		1 to 1/0)
4/0 to 6/0	Whole squid, big cut baits, live baits	Cod, bull redfish, big stripers, catfish, sharks from the shore

Line strengths (mono unless stated):

Line	Use
3 to 4 lb (1.4 to 1.8 kg) hook lengths	Roach, dace, small perch, canal float fishing
6 lb (2.7 kg)	The general freshwater float and light-lure line: perch, trout, bream, chub, bluegill, crappie
8 to 10 lb (3.6 to 4.5 kg)	Carp, tench, bass, walleye, catfish, pike lures (with a wire trace)
12 to 15 lb (5.4 to 6.8 kg)	Pike dead-baiting, big carp, big catfish, light shore fishing
15 to 20 lb (6.8 to 9 kg)	The shore: bass, flounder, cod, stripers; with a 40 to 60 lb shock leader for casting heavy weights from a beach
Braid 10 to 20 lb (4.5 to 9 kg) with a fluorocarbon leader	Lure fishing for everything, once you can cast

Weights. Split shot for floats: sizes SSG (1.6 g), AAA (0.8 g), BB (0.4 g), No. 4 (0.2 g), No. 6 (0.1 g), No. 8 (0.06 g). Ledger: 15 to 30 g (half to one ounce) in still water; 30 to 60 g in rivers; 90 to 150 g (3 to 5 oz) from beaches, gripper (breakaway) leads in surf. Jig heads: 3 to 10 g for perch and bass; 10 to 30 g for the shore.

Appendix B - The Gear Checklist and the Tackle-Box List

Before leaving the house

Licence (on the phone or printed) and the day ticket or club card	()
Rod, reel with line, rod bag	()
Landing net; unhooking mat or towel	()
Tackle box (below); bait; bait box	()
Forceps or pliers; disgorgers; line clippers	()
Chair or bucket; rod rest	()
Sunglasses (polarised); hat; sun cream; insect repellent	()
Water; food; flask	()
Waterproof; warm layer; spare socks	()
Phone in a bag; small first-aid kit (plasters, antiseptic wipe)	()
Bin bag for rubbish and line	()
Tape measure; scales; camera; the log	()
Head torch (evening); life jacket (rocks, pier, wading); tide	(

table (shore)	)
Told someone where you are going and when you will be back	()

The tackle box

Compartment	Contents
Hooks	Barbless: 16, 14, 12, 10, 8 (freshwater); 1/0, 2/0 (shore); a few ready-tied hair rigs; drop-shot hooks
Floats	Two wagglers (2 and 3 AAA), two stick floats, two clip-on bobbers, float rubbers and stops
Weights	Split shot assortment (non-toxic); three 20 g ledger weights; two 60 g shore weights; jig heads 5 and 10 g
Swivels and links	Size 8 and 10 swivels; snap links; ledger beads; a 20 cm wire trace
Lures	Two spinners, one spoon, a packet of soft plastics, one crankbait, one popper, a set of feathers
Line	A spool of 6 lb and one of 10 lb mono; a spool of fluorocarbon for leaders
Tools	Forceps, disgorgers, clippers, a small knife, bait elastic, a plummet, a spare float rubber, a cloth
Odds	Rubber bands, a lighter, a pen, plasters, a spare reel handle screw, a few zip-lock bags

Appendix C - The Fishing Log

One line per trip. After ten trips it tells you when and where you catch; after fifty it is your own book.

Date	Water and swim	Weather, wind, temperature, tide	Method, bait, depth	Time fished	Fish caught (species, size)	What worked, what did not, next time

